Ryan Wendell

Chicago, Illinois · ryanjwendell@gmail.com · (224) 723-4213

Experience

Barista *Aug 2020 — Feb 2021*

Conscious Cup, Barrington, Illinois

Barista in a high-volume, community-focused specialty coffee shop.

- Prepared single-origin espresso, milk drinks, pour-overs, and custom beverages during peak rush hours without sacrificing quality.
- Textured and steamed milk to precise temperatures and consistencies for each drink standard, producing latte art and maintaining quality across high-volume service.
- Operated and maintained coffee equipment including espresso machines, grinders, and brewers; dialed in grinders multiple times daily to ensure optimal extraction.
- Hand-crafted house-made syrups, chai concentrate, and cold brew concentrate in precise batches daily to support high-volume beverage production and ensure consistent flavor quality.
- Followed precise drink recipes and preparation standards to consistently craft high-quality beverages that exceeded customer expectations.
- Completed internal proficiency assessments in espresso calibration and milk texturing for each traditional drink offering.
- Greeted customers warmly, built lasting relationships, and proactively recommended menu options to enhance their experience.
- Recommended and served food items including sandwiches and pastries; handled POS transactions and cash with accuracy.
- Restocked supplies such as cups, lids, coffee beans, syrups, and pastries; monitored expiration dates to ensure freshness and food safety.
- Maintained cleanliness of equipment, countertops, and café seating areas; assisted with opening and closing duties including setup, cleaning, and inventory tasks.

Senior Associate - Software Engineer *Aug 2022 — Feb 2026*

Northern Trust, Chicago, Illinois

Progressed through three roles over 3+ years, leading cross-functional collaboration and process improvement in a demanding corporate environment.

- Led end-to-end delivery of large-scale initiatives across cross-functional and international teams.
- Streamlined operations by consolidating disparate systems, reducing costs while improving availability for stakeholders.
- Produced documentation including specifications, process flowcharts, and maintenance guides to support knowledge transfer.
- Mentored junior team members through reviews, technical guidance, and documented troubleshooting strategies.

Volunteering

Espresso & Milk Steaming Trainer

Junbi Matcha & Tea

- Trained owners and staff how to properly dial-in espresso machine and steam milk for espresso and matcha based drinks.
- Provided support on technique and technical knowledge.

Head Barista

Private Coffee Shop Pop-Up

- Crafted 3–5 specialized seasonal beverages per event alongside a full espresso menu.
- Managed a rush of 30+ simultaneous guests as sole barista.

Education

Iowa State University *Jul 2014 — Jan 2020*

BS - Computer Science